panel at the MLA conference, declares: "I believe that the lessons of the Holocaust call on us to reject any ideology that privileges one group of people over another, which Zionism unfortunately does." In this view, now well established among those who affirm "cosmopolitan" and "progressive" values, to pay proper homage to the memory of the victims of the Holocaust requires that one be an anti-Zionist.

The anti-Zionism that has been emerging in recent years usually has little or nothing to do with Zionism itself. To understand it, one needs to put the stress on the "anti" that precedes the hyphen rather than the "Zionism" that follows it, for what distinguishes anti-Zionism more than anything else is the negative passions it embodies. Through the frequent repetition of a limited but emotionally-charged lexicon of defamatory terms, anti-Zionism has developed a language of its own, conveying in strongly-felt terms a now familiar litany of accusations and indictments directed at the State of Israel. The truth-content of these charges is taken to be self-evident, and in the minds of those who make them, their substance stands in no need of verification. And so Joan Scott feels free to assert that Israeli children "are regularly taught that Arab lives are worth less than Jewish lives." Omar Barghouti states with equal certainty that most Israelis view Palestinians as "less than human" and that sharpshooter Israeli soldiers are guilty of "hunting Palestinian children," "enticing them like mice into playing football and then shooting them with silencers."[12]

Inflammatory statements of this kind, now commonly voiced, are illustrative of what Sarfati has called a "pornographic" dimension of the new antisemitism: "The speakers, listeners, and those who watch all enjoy it." At its most extreme, antisemitic discourse may show parallels to pornography: the more one indulges in such fantasy-laden rhetoric, the more habit-forming it becomes. The fact that it is a bad habit is beside the point, for the people addicted to it are lured by its appeal and will continue to pursue it. In its more normative anti-Zionist formations, though, this discourse, especially when practiced by Jews, reveals something closer to narcissistic pleasures. Whatever the political aims of such rhetoric, the escalation of feeling that accompanies it is self-directed. As evidence, witness how animated, self-righteous, and self-indulgent certain speakers become when they assume an anti-Zionist posture.

The Israeli philosopher Elhanan Yakira locates still another side of this phenomenon, which he calls "virtuous antisemitism," suggesting that those who attack the Jewish state are certain they stand taller than the rest of us and are on the right side of history and morality. Whatever else accounts for this posture of moral rectitude, it is rooted in such ideological imperatives as the

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